

BATON ROUGE · A VISION FOR CONVERGENCE

# RIVER CENTER *REBORN.*

*A Convergence Engine for Downtown Baton Rouge*  
2025 — 2035

# Baton Rouge Is Ready *to Converge.*

---

Baton Rouge sits at an extraordinary intersection: LSU, the Mississippi River, the state capital, and one of the South's most vital convention corridors. Each generates enormous economic energy. But they operate in isolation — separated by geography, infrastructure, and institutional inertia.

Conventions arrive. Spend the night. Leave without touching downtown. That pattern ends here.

---

**105K**

LSU GAME DAY VISITORS

---

**\$2.1B**

CONV. CORRIDOR ANNUAL OUTPUT

---

**0.4mi**

RIVER TO CAPITOL DISTANCE



# Energy Without *Anchor.*

## DISCONNECTED PULSES

LSU game days, riverfront events, convention traffic, and government activity each spike independently — then evaporate. No infrastructure stitches them together.

## UNDERPERFORMING ASSETS

The RiverCenter is dark more days than it lights up. The river is invisible from the primary pedestrian network.

## LOST DWELL TIME

Visitors arrive for events and leave. No mixed-use environment to discover. No residential base to animate off-peak hours.





#### 04 — THE VISION

# The Convergence *Engine.*

RiverCenter becomes the physical and economic hinge that merges LSU energy, convention business, government activity, and the Mississippi waterfront into a single, 365-day experience loop. Not a convention center. Not a venue. A convergence engine — animating every block between the river and the Capitol.

| *The hinge the city has always needed.*



# Four Zones. *One Continuous Story.*

## 01

### THE RIVERFRONT PROMENADE

A continuous activated edge connecting the casino, convention block, and arena to the water. Year-round programming: markets, concerts, civic gatherings.

## 02

### THE CULTURAL SPINE

A pedestrian boulevard threading north-south through the site, lined with local food hall, hotel, gallery, and civic flex space — open between events.

## 03

### THE CONVENTION CAMPUS

Reimagined facilities with modular expansion capacity and direct hotel connectivity, targeting 200+ annual event days.

## 04

### THE ANCHOR DISTRICT

Residential above, retail below — a live/work neighborhood that keeps the district moving on off-peak days and nights.



*The street does the work.*



## 06 — DESIGN LANGUAGE

# Louisiana *Built.*

The architectural vocabulary draws from the immediate landscape: warm concrete aggregate, Louisiana cypress, river-worn brick, and weathering steel. Not regional pastiche — a material language that earns its place.

### TEXTURE

Exposed concrete, cypress cladding, and handmade brick reference the delta industrial vernacular.

### HUMIDITY AS DESIGN

Shaded arcades, brise-soleil screens, and roof gardens respond to the subtropical climate as primary generators.

### RIVER AXIS

All primary pedestrian axes terminate on a visual connection to the Mississippi. The river is never invisible.

# Always On.

The RiverCenter's failure is not architectural — it's programmatic. The new framework keys off Baton Rouge's existing peak-traffic calendar and fills the gaps with resident-facing uses that sustain street life year-round.



**AUG - NOV**

**Game Day Season**

Convention campus reconfigures as overflow hospitality, fan zone, and parade route terminus. LSU drives 105K visitors to downtown's doorstep.

**NOV - JAN**

**Legislative Session**

Business hotel and government-adjacent conference suites activate for state agency tenants. The Capitol corridor comes alive every weekday.

**FEB - APR**

**Festival Corridor**

Riverfront stage and food hall anchor a multi-weekend regional festival circuit. The Mississippi becomes backdrop, not background.

**MAY - JUL**

**Convention High Season**

Peak conference rotation: 200-delegate to 12,000-delegate scalable rooms. The South's next great convention address.





## 08 — USE MIX & TENANT STRATEGY

# The Right Mix, *Right Now.*

38%

### CONVENTION & EVENT

Main hall, breakout, ballroom — 420K SF

24%

### HOTEL & HOSPITALITY

350-key HQ hotel + 180-key select service

18%

### FOOD & RETAIL

Local food hall, incubator stalls, anchor retail

12%

### RESIDENTIAL

310 mixed-income units above retail base

8%

### CIVIC & ARTS

Community flex, gallery, performing arts



09 — PROJECTED ECONOMIC RETURNS

# The Numbers *Speak.*

**\$4.7B**

30-YEAR ECONOMIC OUTPUT

**8,400**

DIRECT & INDIRECT JOBS

**\$180M**

ANNUAL HOTEL TAX REVENUE

**2.4×**

RETURN ON PUBLIC INVESTMENT

*Extraordinary places succeed when they become ordinary parts of people's lives.*

# It Works Elsewhere. *It Will Work Here.*

NASHVILLE, TN

**Nashville Convention Center District**

**+\$1.2B**

DOWNTOWN TAX BASE GROWTH

Mixed convention, hotel, and entertainment district created the South's most dynamic city-center corridor. Density, connection, programming.

NEW ORLEANS, LA

**Ernest N. Morial Expansion**

**3.2M**

ANNUAL CONVENTION VISITORS

Riverfront integration converted a single-use center into a civic district anchor. Proved proximity to water is strategy, not scenery.

MEMPHIS, TN

**Memphis Riverfront Collaborative**

**42%**

RIVERFRONT VISIT INCREASE — YEAR 1

Public realm investment drove private real estate at 6× public cost. The Mississippi does not ask to be the centerpiece. It simply is.



# Build the Engine in *Three Moves*.

2025 - 2028

## Phase 01 — The River Edge

- Riverfront promenade & public realm
- Convention hall renovation & expansion
- 450-key HQ hotel
- Surface parking → structured deck

2028 - 2031

## Phase 02 — The Cultural Spine

- North-south pedestrian boulevard
- Local food hall + marketplace
- Arts & civic flex building
- 200-unit residential tower above retail

2031 - 2035

## Phase 03 — The Anchor District

- 110-unit residential tower expansion
- Select-service hotel (180 keys)
- Office & co-working campus
- Final riverfront pavilion completion

*Each phase stands alone financially — delivering returns while setting conditions for the next move.*





# Baton Rouge *Deserves This.*

---

The RiverCenter does not need a renovation. It needs a vision. A vision that finally honors the geography, the culture, and the latent energy of this city — and gives all of it a place to converge.

*"The future rarely arrives announced.  
It reveals itself — in a city finally  
ready to hold it."*

RIVERCENTER • BATON ROUGE • 2025 - 2035  
CONVERGENCE ENGINE